



Saint-Jean-Baptiste
Educational Foundation

NEWSLETTER

SJBEF is an Affiliate of Catholic Financial Life

2023

Paul R. Plante
Trustee and Chair
plantepri@gmail.com
401-486-1826

Paul Pinsonnault
Administrative Secretary
paulduckpin@yahoo.com

Ken Boivin
Trustee and Treasurer
ken.boivin22@gmail.com

Celeste Feren
Trustee
mrsferen@gmail.com

Susan Griffiths
Trustee
msgriff2016@gmail.com

Bruce Laverriere
Trustee
blaverriere@yahoo.com

Lynette Ouellette
Trustee
frnchconnect39@gmail.com

John Borgen
President & CEO
Catholic Financial Life

Saint-Jean-Baptiste
Educational Foundation
P.O. Box 275
Woonsocket, RI 02895



1100 W. Wells Street
Milwaukee, WI 53233
(800) 927-2547 | cfl.org

Dear Fraternal Brothers and Sisters,

I am pleased to provide you once again with an update on the Saint-Jean-Baptiste Educational Foundation (SJBEF.)

We were fortunate this year that our investment returns, despite the failing economy, were slightly better than expected. That along with your generous 2022 donations allowed us to increase our Member Scholarships to the amount of \$1,000, up from \$800 last year. In addition, we were able to increase our Seminarian Scholarships to \$900, up from \$800 last year. We continued to present the Shrine of Our Lady of La Salette with two \$800 scholarships. Speaking of La Salette, we celebrated our 69th Annual Pilgrimage this year! We look forward to seeing as many of you as possible next year at our 70th Annual Pilgrimage. Save the date - Sunday, September 8, 2024!

This year we introduced a new Grant/Scholarship Program for Catholic elementary, middle, and high schools in New England. Each of our New England chapters was asked to nominate a Catholic school to receive a grant in the amount of \$500. The chapters were also asked to make an in-person presentation on behalf of their chapter and the SJBEF. The new program was a tremendous success, with 75% of our New England chapters participating.

I would like to announce that this is my last year serving as Chair of the Foundation. I especially would like to thank all of the Trustees for their hard work and support, to Catholic Financial Life for their continued support, and to all of the New England members as well. I will continue as a Trustee, assuming the position of Vice-Chair.

Congratulations to Trustee Bruce Laverriere from Chapter N120, Biddeford, Maine, who will be the new Chair of the SJBEF. I can assure you that Bruce is a dedicated New England member and that he will continue with the good works of the Foundation.

Lastly, I would like to ask you to continue with your generous donations to the SJBEF, which helps to make all of the scholarships possible. If your chapter is looking for an activity, a Match Fund event for the Foundation is always greatly appreciated.

Wishing all of you a very blessed holiday season, Merry Christmas, and a safe and healthy 2024.

Paul R. Plante

SJBEF Chair

Financial Report

Ken Boivin

Another year has flown by. Inflation is still of concern as interest rates continue to climb. The stock market is up one week and down another. Through all this turmoil, the SJBEF is still on solid ground. The Chicago Trust Company, together with Great Lakes Advisors LLC, continue to manage our investments wisely.

Through your generosity, the 2023 fundraising campaign brought in over \$5,000. Our 2024 fundraising campaign is about to get underway and we are

hoping to raise even more. Remember that SJBEF is a 501c3 and your donation is tax deductible.

Our mission is to raise funds for scholarships and grants. We do this through our fundraisers and our investment income. So far this year we have awarded \$32,000 in College Scholarships, \$8,200 in Seminarian Scholarships, and \$8,500 in Catholic School Grants. The Catholic Schools receiving grants are chosen by the New England Chapters.

If you have questions, feel free to contact me at ken.boivin22@gmail.com.

2023 Award Highlights

Paul Pinsonnault

This was once again a banner year for SJBEF awards. There were repeat disbursements and also a new initiative. Included in these awards are the following:

COLLEGE SCHOLARSHIPS: 32 scholarships were awarded to deserving applicants this year. Once again there were students from each New England state, with 15 being from Massachusetts, nine from Maine, five from Rhode Island and one each from Connecticut, New Hampshire, and Vermont. GPAs were again outstanding, and students will be attending colleges from the East to West coasts. Foundation earnings were such that the Trustees voted to increase the scholarship amounts this year to \$1,000. Recipients are to be congratulated for their hard work and we wish them continued success.

Scholarship Recipients

Connecticut Mary Kalberg | **Massachusetts** Alexander Cormier, Brenna Dushinski, Caroline Puccini, Cecilia Eluszkiewicz, Ella Gesner, Jack Hebert, Jason Pinsonnault, Jonathan Cabral, Lauren O'Donald, Madeleine Brodeur, Mariana Hebert, Nicole Ledwidge, Sarah Downing, Sophia Puccini, Victoria Eluszkiewicz | **Maine** Alexander Bryant, Chantel Smith, Emmanuelle Richie, Lauren Theriault, Lucy Frenette, Makenzie Parent, Miles Frenette, Morgan Capener, Zoe Petit | **New Hampshire** Audrey Pilotte | **Rhode Island** Brooke Forget, Conor Grew, Ellie Buttaro, Maeve Dujardin, Monique Grew | **Vermont** Nicole Dirmaier

SEMINARIAN SCHOLARSHIPS: Seminarians from eight New England Dioceses were awarded scholarships. Each Diocese was offered \$900 to be distributed to either one or two seminarians. Most decided to assist those in the program. This year the Foundation will be able to support 17 men furthering their priestly studies. The Providence Diocese received an additional scholarship in the amount of \$1,000, made in honor of Bishop Louis Gelineau. In addition, two \$800 scholarships were allocated to the La Salette Order to assist those studying for the La Salette Priesthood and Brotherhood.



Grant Recipient:
Chapter N042,
North Attleboro,
MA to Bishop Feehan
High School in
Attleboro, MA



Grant Recipient:
Chapter N002,
Woonsocket, RI to
Greater Woonsocket
Catholic Regional
School



Grant Recipient: Chapter N084,
Gardner, MA to Holy Rosary Academy
Middle School in Gardner, MA



Grant Recipient:
Chapter N441, Westport, MA
to St. Stanislaus Elementary
School in Fall River, MA.



Grant Recipient: Chapter
N442, Somerset, MA to
St. Michael Elementary School
(SMS) in Fall River, MA.

GRANTS: Since resources were available this year, Foundation Chair Paul Plante proposed to the Trustees the possibility of making grants to Catholic schools recommended by chapter leaders. The suggestion was accepted, and 18 Grants of \$500 each were given to a Catholic elementary, middle, or high school as recommended by the chapters. Check presentations were made to each school by chapter leaders.

FRENCH AWARDS: The Foundation has had generous contributions made by members to assist in the study of the French language. The review of applicants is near completion and funds will be awarded before year-end.



Grant Recipient:
Chapter N373, New
Britain, CT to East
Catholic High School
in Manchester, CT



Grant Recipient:
Chapter N091, Manchester, NH
to Cardinal Lacroix Academy in
Manchester, NH